



Eversheds Sutherland: PMO Turnaround & Service Delivery

A case study in rapid stabilisation, governance restoration, and building a centre of excellence.

The Challenge: A PMO in Crisis

Fragmented Governance

Disconnected structures undermining decision-making and accountability across the organisation.

Visibility Gaps

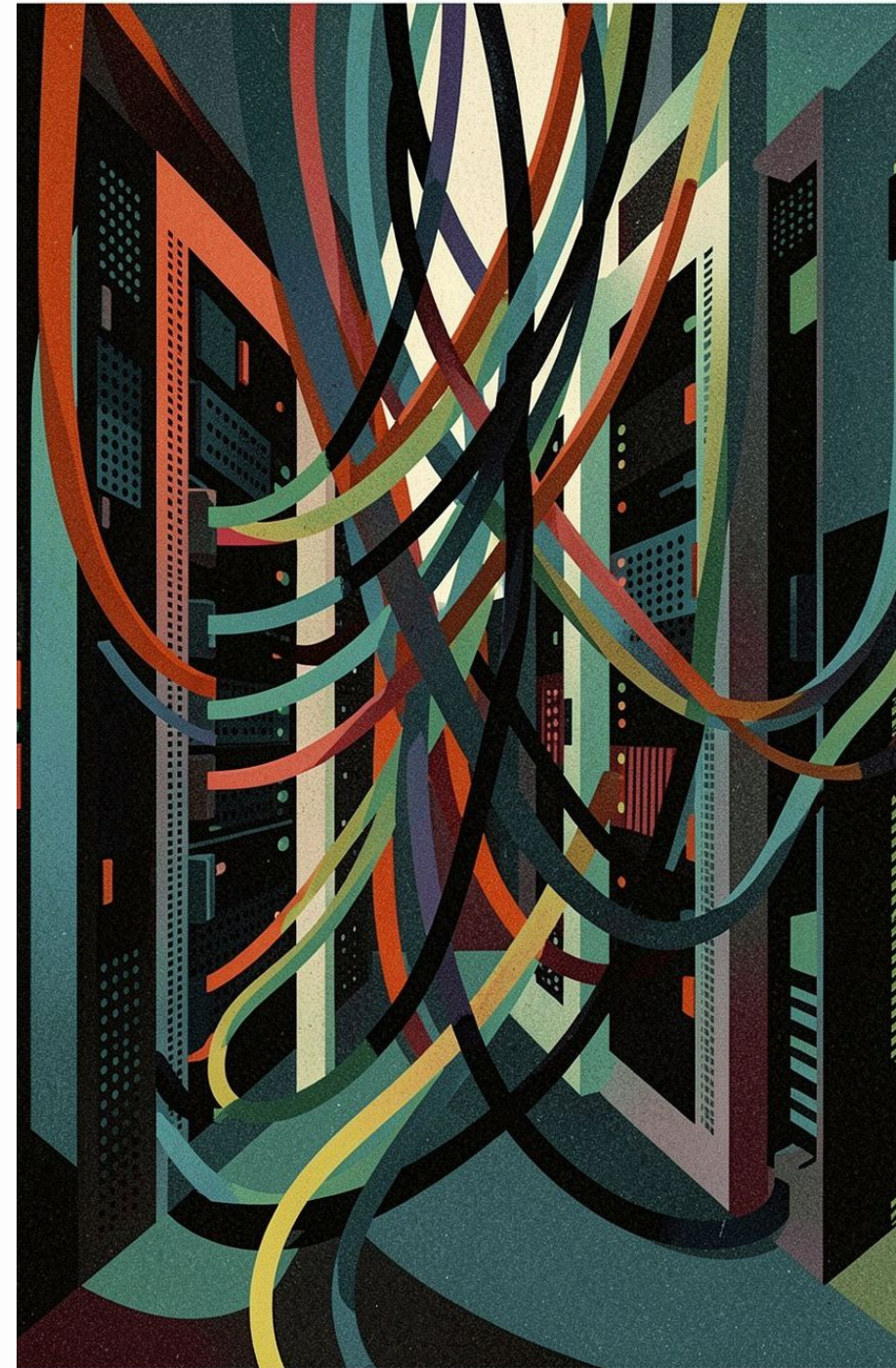
Inconsistent reporting left stakeholders without a clear, reliable picture of delivery status.

Eroded Confidence

Limited stakeholder trust in the PMO's capacity to drive and protect delivery outcomes.

Reactive Posture

A support function unable to shift from firefighting to generating genuine strategic value.



The Mandate: Stabilise, Restore, Rebuild



1 Stabilise

Regain operational control and halt the deterioration of PMO delivery performance.

2 Restore

Rebuild stakeholder confidence through transparent, consistent governance.

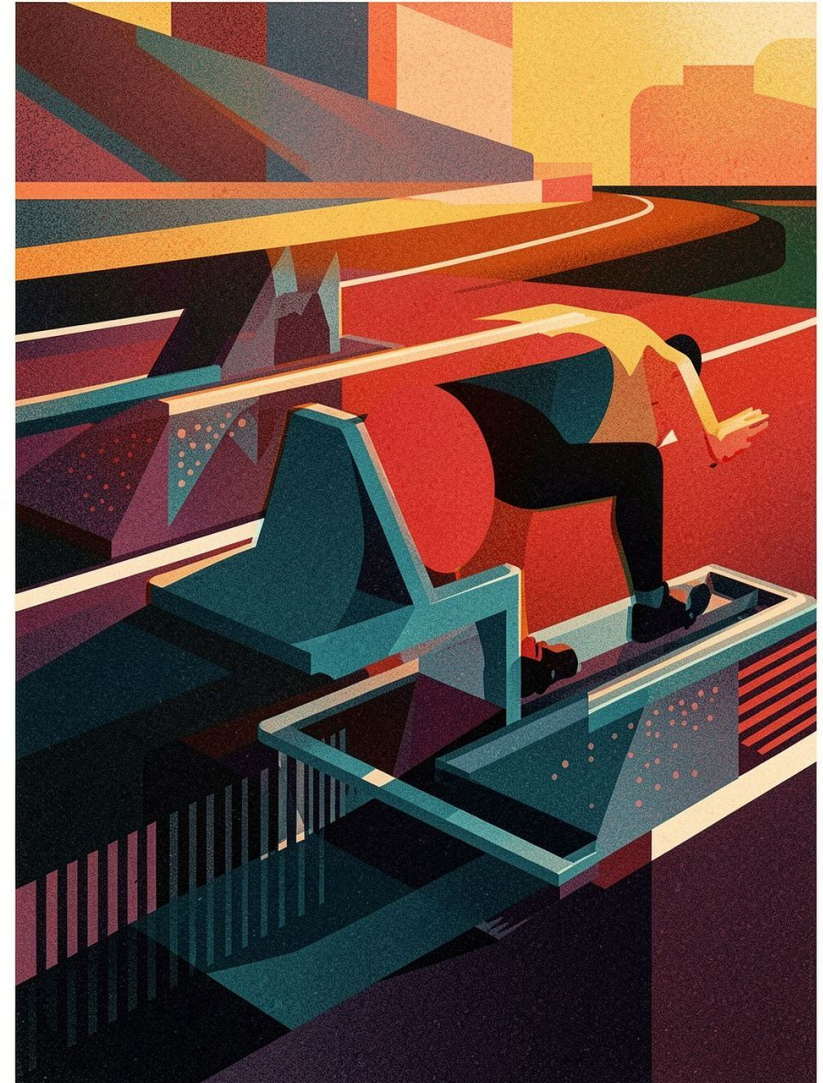
3 Rebuild

Transform the PMO from a reactive support function into a trusted, proactive delivery partner.

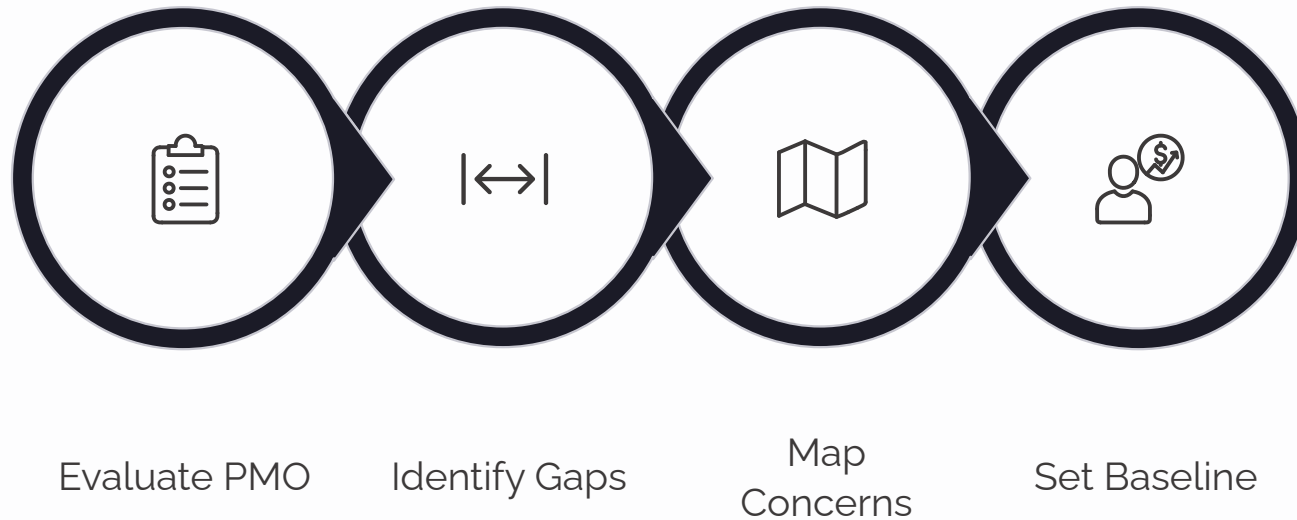
CASE STUDY

Phase 1: Rapid Turnaround

Swift, structured intervention to arrest decline and re-establish the foundations of delivery control.



Assessment & Diagnosis



What We Found

A rapid but rigorous diagnostic exercise uncovered the root causes of PMO dysfunction:

- Process gaps and inefficiencies embedded across delivery workflows
- Unclear accountability creating blind spots in ownership and escalation
- Stakeholder pain points concentrated around reporting reliability and responsiveness
- No established baseline to measure performance or track improvement

Intervention: Introducing Structure

Redefined Operating Model

Aligned the PMO to business priorities and the realities of on-the-ground delivery.

Standardised Governance

Established clear decision rights, escalation paths, and accountability frameworks.

Improved Reporting

Introduced consistent cadence and meaningful metrics to replace ad hoc, unreliable outputs.

Clear Ownership

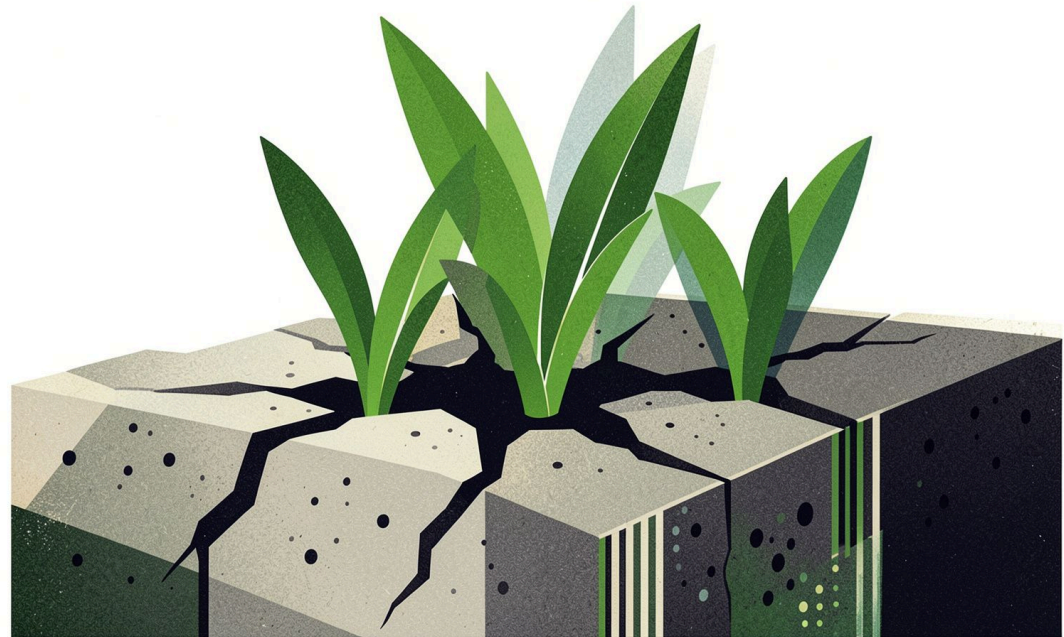
Defined accountability across every delivery stream — no more ambiguity at critical junctures.



Results: Weeks to Stability

The turnaround delivered measurable change at pace — transforming the PMO's standing within the organisation and with key stakeholders.

- Operational stability and delivery visibility restored
- Stakeholder confidence rebuilt through transparent governance
- PMO repositioned as a proactive delivery partner
- Foundations set for long-term service excellence





CASE STUDY

Phase 2: Stabilisation & Service Delivery

With immediate stability secured, focus shifted to embedding lasting maturity and positioning the PMO as a strategic centre of excellence.

Embedding Maturity & Consistency



Performance Visibility

KPI dashboards and performance metrics introduced real-time visibility across all delivery activity.



Structured Assurance

Enhanced stakeholder engagement through formal assurance processes and disciplined review cadences.



Continuous Improvement

A culture of ongoing refinement embedded across the PMO – sustaining gains and raising the standard over time.

Building a Centre of Excellence

From Crisis Response to Strategic Partner

The engagement concluded not with a handover, but with a transformation. The PMO was repositioned as a genuine strategic enabler – equipped with the frameworks, talent, and governance architecture to drive business outcomes at scale.

- ❏ The strongest PMOs are not administrators of process – they are architects of delivery confidence.

1

Capability Frameworks

Structured development pathways for PMO team growth.

2

Standardised Methodologies

Consistent delivery practices and documented best standards.

3

Governance Quality Gates

Assurance checkpoints embedded at critical delivery milestones.

4

Strategic Positioning

PMO recognised as an enabler of business outcomes, not a cost centre.